WorkNest Admin Demo Script

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A 6-minute spoken walkthrough of the WorkNest admin dashboard: what to click, and what to say while you do.

Before you start

Set these up at least 10 minutes before presenting, so every page has data and nothing fails live.

- [ ] Start the server (`npm run dev` in `server/`), then the frontend (`npm run dev`); open http://localhost:5000/api/health and check it says `ok`
- [ ] Run `npm run seed` and then `npm run seed-candidates` in `server/`, so there are jobs, clients and 14 candidates
- [ ] Make your account an admin: `npm run make-admin -- you@email.com`, then log out and back in
- [ ] Open two browser windows: one logged in as **admin**, one (incognito) logged in as a **candidate**
- [ ] As the candidate, apply to one job before the talk, so the Pipeline has an application you can move live
- [ ] Zoom the browser to 125% so the back of the room can read it
- [ ] Close other tabs and turn off notifications

The script

Seven stops, about 6 minutes in total. **Do** is what you click; **Say** is what you tell the audience, in your own words.

1. Opening (20 seconds)

Do: Start on the WorkNest home page in the admin window.

Say: "So far you've seen WorkNest from the candidate's side. Now I'll show you the other half: the admin dashboard our recruitment team uses to post jobs, manage clients and hire candidates."

2. Getting in, and why it's protected (30 seconds)

Do: Open your account menu in the navbar, then go to `/admin`.

Say: "Only admins and recruiters can open this. A candidate who types this address is sent straight back to the home page. And the real check isn't in the browser: every admin request goes to the server with a login token, and the server rejects it if the role isn't admin or recruiter."

3. Overview (1 minute)

Do: Stay on the Overview page. Point at the six stat cards, then scroll down slowly.

Say: "This is the recruiter's morning view. At the top: **Active jobs**, **Registered candidates**, **Applications received**, **Shortlisted**, **Interviews scheduled** and **Placements made**, each with how it changed this week or month."

Say (scrolling): "Below that: the latest applications, how many sit at each stage, which jobs close soon, the most-applied roles, and a pipeline snapshot. The server builds all of this in one request, running the database queries side by side so the page loads quickly."

Do: Point at the sidebar counts.

Say: "The numbers beside Jobs, Clients and Candidates come from the same request."

4. Jobs and creating a role (1 minute)

Do: Click **Jobs**. Use the search box to type a client name, then clear it.

Say: "Every job in every status: open, draft, closed. We can search by role or client."

Do: Click **New job** (top right). Fill in **Job title**, pick a **Client**, then scroll to the screening questions and add one: "Why are you interested in this role?"

Say: "Creating a role takes one form: the client, job type, work arrangement, experience level, salary range and deadline. The part I like most is **screening questions**: the recruiter writes their own, and candidates must answer every one before they can apply."

Do: Either save it, or go back without saving so the job list stays tidy.

5. Clients (45 seconds)

Do: Click **Clients**. Then click one client card to open its detail page.

Say: "These are the companies WorkNest hires for. Each card shows open roles and placements, worked out live from the jobs and applications, not typed in by hand. Inside a client, we see its roles and total applicants, and an admin can upload the company logo, which is stored on Cloudinary."

6. Candidates (45 seconds)

Do: Click **Candidates**. Type "Figma" in the search box, then pick **Senior** under experience, then reset.

Say: "Every registered candidate, with their location, experience level, skills and how many times they've applied. We can search by name, headline or skill, and filter by experience, availability and status."

Do: Point at a **Placed** pill and an **Employed** pill.

Say: "Status is worked out for us: **Placed** means WorkNest hired them for a role; **Employed** means they told us they're not looking right now; everyone else is **Open to work**."

7. Pipeline: reviewing a real application (1.5 minutes)

This is the highlight, so slow down.

Do: Click **Pipeline**, then open the application your candidate account sent before the talk.

Say: "Here's an application a candidate sent a few minutes ago. We see everything they submitted: their details, CV, links, their answers to our screening questions, and why they want the role."

Do: Score the scorecard (Skills match, Experience, Communication, Portfolio / work), type a short internal note, and click **Save notes & score**.

Say: "The team scores each candidate out of 5 on four areas, and leaves notes. These are internal: the candidate never sees them."

Do: Move the stage to **Shortlisted**.

Say: "Now I'll move them to Shortlisted. That one click records the change in the application's history, emails the candidate, and creates a notification for them."

Do: Switch to the candidate window and open **Applications**.

Say: "And here's the candidate's side: the stage has updated, and the notification is waiting. That's the whole loop, from posting a job to moving a real applicant forward."

Closing line (10 seconds)

Say: "That's the admin side of WorkNest: one place for the recruitment team to post roles, manage clients and move every candidate through hiring. Happy to take questions."

If something goes wrong

Stay calm, say one sentence about what happened, and move on; the audience cares about the product, not the glitch.

What you see	Quick fix	What to say
"Network Error" toasts	The server stopped. Restart `npm run dev` in `server/`	"The server took a break; let me restart it."
Pages are empty	Seed data is missing. Run `npm run seed-candidates`	"Let me load our demo data."
`/admin` sends you to the home page	Your account isn't an admin, or you didn't log back in after `make-admin`	"That's the role check working; I'm on the wrong account."
No application in Pipeline	Apply from the candidate window now; it takes 30 seconds	"Let's send one live."
The candidate window doesn't show the new stage	Refresh the Applications page	(nothing; just refresh)
A page errors out completely	Skip to the next stop and come back if there's time	"I'll come back to that one."

Questions you may get

Question	Short answer
How does someone become an admin?	They sign up like anyone else; then we run `npm run make-admin` with their email on the server. There's no self-service, on purpose.
What stops a candidate calling the admin API directly?	The server checks the role inside their login token on every request and returns 403 Forbidden.
What's the difference between an admin and a recruiter?	Today both can use the whole dashboard. Limiting recruiters to their own clients is on our roadmap.
Can the candidate see the scorecard or notes?	No. Scores and internal notes are never sent to the candidate's side of the API.
What happens when you change a stage?	It's saved to the application's history, the candidate gets an email through Brevo, and an in-app notification.

Question	Short answer
How are the dashboard numbers calculated?	Live from the database on each visit, with the queries run in parallel; nothing is stored or typed by hand.
Where are logos and CVs stored?	On Cloudinary; the database only keeps the link.
What if a job's deadline passes?	It disappears from job listings automatically, and applying to it is blocked on the server.